

Letter from Mokurai Genmyō (黙雷玄明) — Transcription & Translation

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Handwritten calligraphy letter, first page of a set of documents delivered by post (not email) from 釈妙円 / Mokurai Genmyō, addressed to Rob Oudendijk. Source scan: docs/energy-forest/source-scans/from temple/S9090001.jpg.

Japanese (transcription)

Title (large calligraphy, top right):

人生楽有相知心

Body (right to left):

人生、楽しさは相知の心に在り。

真心もった御手紙ありがたく拝見いたしました。

これを御縁に未熟者の私をよろしく御教導賜りますよう一重にお願い申し上げます。

楽しさは新たに相知るあり。楽しきこなし。

いずれ祥眉の上。

令和八年九月二十三日 合掌

勸進僧 黙雷

オウデンダイク・ロブ様

Left-hand note (author's own biography):

○俗名・遙雄（いつお）、得度（出家）して玄明ということとなり、七十歳で〈戸籍名〉伊藤黙雷（もくらい）と改名しました。

English (translation)

Title:

"Life's joy lies in the heart that knows another."

Body:

In life, joy lies in the heart of mutual understanding.

I have gratefully and respectfully read your heartfelt letter.

Taking this connection (*goen*) as an opportunity, I humbly and wholeheartedly ask that you kindly extend your guidance and instruction to this still-unaccomplished student of the Way.

Joy is found anew in coming to know one another. May happiness attend us.

I hope before long to see your smiling face again.

23rd day of the 9th month, Reiwa 8 (September 23, 2026). Palms together (*gasshō*).

Kanjin-sō (itinerant fundraising monk) Mokurai

To Mr. Rob Oudendijk

Left-hand note:

My lay (secular) name was Itsuo (遼雄). Upon taking Buddhist tonsure (*shukke*) I became known by the Buddhist name Genmyō. At seventy years of age I changed my legal family-register name to Itō Mokurai (伊藤黙雷).

Notes

- This confirms, in the author's own hand, the identity already established in [docs/reference/mokurai_biography.md](#) and [docs/reference/shaku_myoen_biography.md](#): lay name Itsuo → Buddhist name Genmyō (玄明) → legal name changed at 70 to Itō Mokurai (伊藤黙雷).
- Two red seals appear on the page: a header seal (引首印) at the top right of the title, and a name seal beside the signature. The header seal, read closely, appears to be a single seal-script character — likely 雷 (Rai) alone, using the classic spiral "thunder-pattern" (雷文) motif for the lower strokes with the 雨 (rain) radical on top — functioning as an abbreviated art-name seal. The seal beside the signature reads 黙雷 (Mokurai), matching the handwritten signature.
- This is the first page of a larger set of documents delivered to Rob's postbox on 2026-09-25; remaining pages not yet transcribed.